

095. Chapter 7 Verses 17-19

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 7.17

तेषां ज्ञानी नित्ययुक्त एकभक्तिर्विशिष्यते ।
प्रियो हि ज्ञानिनोऽत्यर्थमहं स च मम प्रियः ॥ 17 ॥

teṣāṃ jñānī nityayukta
ekabhaktirviśiṣyate |
priyo hi jñānino'tyartham
ahaṃ sa ca mama priyaḥ ||

teṣāṃ – of them; jñānī – the man of wisdom; nitya-yuktaḥ – ever-steadfast;
eka-bhaktiḥ – whose devotion is to the One; viśiṣyate – excels/is best;
priyaḥ – dear; hi – indeed; jñāninaḥ – to the wise; atyartham – exceedingly;
aham – I; saḥ – he; ca – and; mama – to Me; priyaḥ – dear.

Of these, the wise man, ever steadfast and devoted to the One alone, is the best. For supremely dear am I to the man of wisdom, and he is dear to Me.

VERSE 7.18

उदाराः सर्व एवैते ज्ञानी त्वात्मैव मे मतम् ।
आस्थितः स हि युक्तात्मा मामेवानुत्तमां गतिम् ॥ 18 ॥

udārāḥ sarva evaite
jñānī tvātmaiva me matam |
āsthitaḥ sa hi yuktātmā
māmevānuttamāṃ gatim ||

udārāḥ – noble; **sarve** – all; **eva** – indeed; **ete** – these;
jñānī – the wise; **tu** – but; **ātmā eva** – My very Self; **me matam** – My opinion;
āsthitaḥ – established; **saḥ** – he; **hi** – indeed; **yukta-ātmā** – steady-minded;
mām eva – in Me alone; **anuttamām** – the supreme; **gatim** – goal.

**Noble indeed are they all; but the man endowed with wisdom
I deem to be My very Self. For, steadfast in mind, he remains
fixed in Me alone as the Supreme Goal.**

VERSE 7.19

बहूनां जन्मनामन्ते ज्ञानवान्मां प्रपद्यते ।
वासुदेवः सर्वमिति स महात्मा सुदुर्लभः ॥ 19 ॥

bahūnām janmanāmante
jñānavānmām prapadyate |
vāsudevaḥ sarvamiti sa
mahātmā sudurlabhaḥ ||

- ◆ **bahūnām** – of many; **janmanām** – of births; **ante** – at the end;
- ◆ **jñānavān** – the man of wisdom; **mām** – to Me; **prapadyate** – surrenders;
- ◆ **vāsudevaḥ sarvam** – Vasudeva (God) is everything; **iti** – thus;
- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **mahā-ātmā** – great soul; **su-durlabhaḥ** – very rare.

At the end of many births the man of wisdom seeks refuge in Me, realizing that Vāsudeva is all. Rare indeed is such a high-souled person.